

The Daily Drill Programme

F8.0 — How to Run the 80-Mark Block as Thirty Minutes a Day Instead of a Module You Never Reach

Module	Foundation Layer — Module 8 — English, Quantitative Aptitude & Reasoning
Chapter	Chapter F8.0
Topic	Official syllabus heads A and 7 — General English; Elementary Mathematics, Statistics and General Mental Ability
Version	v1.0
Compiled	16 August 2026
Exam stage	Recruitment Test (RT)

MUST MASTER · WHY THIS DOCUMENT EXISTS

Module 8 is **80 planning marks — the largest single block in the paper**, larger than Labour Laws. And Blueprint §10.2 item 9 says it must be *"never a block; distributed daily practice from week 1."*

Those two facts together create the problem this programme solves. A module that is never a block is a module with no obvious moment to start, which is exactly why it gets postponed — and postponing the largest block in the paper is the most expensive mistake available to you.

So this chapter is not a chapter. It is a schedule. It tells you, for each of the next 72 study days, precisely which questions to attempt in your evening thirty minutes. No planning decisions, no "what should I do today", no chapter to finish first.

Start tomorrow. Week 1, Monday. The material already exists.

Table of Contents

0. The Honest Position on This Programme

1. The Thirty-Minute Template

1.1 Your per-question time budget

2. What the 2023 Paper Actually Asked

2.1 English — 20 questions in 2023

2.2 Quantitative Aptitude — 15 questions in 2023

3. The Twelve-Week Calendar

3.1 Weeks 1 to 4 — first pass through Module 8

3.2 Weeks 5 to 8 — interleaving with the other modules

3.3 Weeks 9 to 12 — error-log drilling and timed sections

4. The Speed Material

4.1 Numbers you should never compute

4.2 The vocabulary drip — ten words a day

5. The Error Log

5.1 The weekly review, fifteen minutes on Saturday

6. Attempt Strategy for the Real Paper

6.1 The three-pass method

0. The Honest Position on This Programme

Two things you should know before relying on it.

What this programme is. A **scheduler over question banks that already exist**. Across Modules 6, 7, 9 and 8 this manual now contains **several hundred practice questions** with worked explanations. The calendar in §3 assigns them to specific days in an order designed to interleave subjects and revisit material at spaced intervals.

What it is not. It is not several hundred *new* questions written for the calendar. Authoring a fresh drill set for every one of 72 days at the standard of the chapter question banks is not something I can do honestly in one sitting, and a padded set of low-quality items would be worse than none — you would be practising against questions that do not resemble the paper.

NOTE · WHAT THAT MEANS IN PRACTICE

For roughly the **first six weeks** the calendar draws on the chapter banks, which is more than enough material. From **week 7** it moves to **second-pass and error-log re-drilling**, which is not a weakness — spaced repetition of questions you got wrong is more valuable than fresh questions you get right.

Where you need genuinely new volume beyond that, the honest answer is **previous years' papers and a commercial question bank**, used as raw material. Blueprint §22 permits coaching material as *supplementary* — this is exactly the case it was written for.

1. The Thirty-Minute Template

Blueprint §11.1 divides your evening hour into 10 minutes of active recall, 20 minutes of consolidation, and 30 minutes of conversion practice. **This programme owns that last 30 minutes.**

Minutes	Activity
0 – 2	Read the day's cell in the §3 calendar. Open the named question set. Note the start time
2 – 22	Attempt the questions. Timed. No looking anything up. Write answers on paper, not in your head
22 – 28	Check. Read the explanation for every question, including the ones you got right
28 – 30	Log every error in the §5 format. This step is the one that compounds

MUST MASTER · THE TWO RULES THAT MAKE THE THIRTY MINUTES WORK

Rule 1 — the evening subject must differ from the morning subject. Blueprint §11.1 requires it, and the calendar in §3 enforces it. Interleaving different material improves retention substantially more than massing the same subject, and it also guarantees English and Quant get daily attention without ever needing a dedicated block of weeks.

Rule 2 — time yourself from day one. The RT gives you **120 questions in 120 minutes**. An untimed correct answer is worth very little, because the constraint that decides your score is not whether you *can* solve a mensuration problem but whether you can solve it in **ninety seconds**. Practising untimed builds a skill you cannot use.

1.1 Your per-question time budget

The paper averages one minute per question, but the average conceals the strategy. Some formats must be done faster than average so that others can be done slower.

Format	Target time	Why
Vocabulary in context	20–30 seconds	You either know the word or you do not. Deliberating does not help
Grammar, error spotting	30–40 seconds	Pattern recognition
Para jumbles	60–75 seconds for a set	Find the opener, then chain
Reading comprehension	5 minutes for the whole passage set	Read once properly, then answer all five
Arithmetic, ratio, percentage	45–60 seconds	Mostly one-step once set up
Mensuration, geometry	75–90 seconds	Formula plus arithmetic
Data interpretation	3 minutes for a set of three	One reading of the table serves all three
Labour law, accounting recall	20–30 seconds	Recall or move on

The arithmetic that matters: if you spend 25 seconds on each of 10 vocabulary questions instead of 60, you bank **six minutes** — which is four extra mensuration problems. Speed on the cheap formats is what buys time for the expensive ones.

2. What the 2023 Paper Actually Asked

The calendar's weighting is not arbitrary. It follows the observed shape of the block (PYQ-DERIVED, Blueprint §4.4).

2.1 English — 20 questions in 2023

Format	Questions	Share
Vocabulary in context	10	half of the English block
Para jumbles	5	a quarter
Reading comprehension — all on one passage	5	a quarter

2.2 Quantitative Aptitude — 15 questions in 2023

Mensuration of a hemisphere and of a melted disc · circle geometry · quadratic roots · probability · ratio and ages · mixtures · **three** data-interpretation questions · heights and distances · mean of weights.

MUST MASTER · THE TWO FINDINGS THAT SHOULD CHANGE YOUR STUDY PLAN

Finding 1 — vocabulary is half the English block. Ten of twenty questions. No other single format in the entire paper carries that concentration. It is also the format most improved by **daily drip exposure** rather than by study sessions, which is the strongest argument for this programme's existence. §4 gives you the drip.

Finding 2 — there was only ONE pure reasoning question. One, out of 120. Blueprint §4.4 records it explicitly.

That second finding is worth pausing on, because "General Mental Ability" appears in the official syllabus and every commercial book for this exam devotes hundreds of pages to reasoning — syllogisms, blood relations, coding-decoding, seating arrangements. On the 2023 evidence that is a **very poor use of your hours**. Module 8 therefore treats reasoning as **one compact chapter (F8.8)**, not as a third of the module. If you have a reasoning book, use it as a doorstop until the core is safe.

3. The Twelve-Week Calendar

How to use it. Find the week, find the day, do what the cell says. Each cell names a chapter section and a question range. F8.1 §7 Q1–20 means chapter F8.1, section 7, questions 1 to 20.

Sunday is deliberately blank — use it for a full mock or leave it alone.

3.1 Weeks 1 to 4 — first pass through Module 8

Week	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat
1	F8.1 §7 Q1–20	F8.5 §8 Q1–12	F8.1 §7 Q21–40	F8.5 §8 Q13–24	F8.2 §6 Q1–10	Speed tables §4.1, timed
2	F8.4 §7 Q1–15	F8.6 §7 Q1–10	F8.4 §7 Q16–30	F8.6 §7 Q11–20	F8.2 §6 Q11–20	Error log review
3	F8.3 §6 Q1–10	F8.7 §7 Q1–10	F8.3 §6 Q11–20	F8.7 §7 Q11–20	F8.8 §6 Q1–12	Speed tables, timed
4	F8.1 §7 Q1–40, re-drill	F8.5 §8 Q25–35	F8.4 §7 re- drill	F8.6 §7 Q21–30	F8.8 §6 Q13–25	Error log review

3.2 Weeks 5 to 8 — interleaving with the other modules

By now Module 8's own banks have been seen once. These weeks interleave them with the numerical and recall material from Modules 6 and 9, which is what Blueprint §11.1's interleaving rule is for.

Week	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat
5	F8.1 vocabulary, errors only	F6.8 §6 Q1– 12 (statistics)	F8.2 §6 re- drill	F9.1 §6 Q21– 30 (numericals)	F8.7 §7 Q21–30	Timed English section
6	F8.3 §6 re-drill	F8.5 §8 errors only	F8.4 §7 errors only	F8.6 §7 errors only	F9.5 §7 Q11–20 (conversions)	Timed Quant section
7	F8.1 vocabulary, errors only	F6.8 §6 Q13–25	F8.2 §6 errors only	F9.2 §6 Q11– 20	F8.8 §6 errors only	Error log review
8	Mixed: 10 vocabulary + 5 quant	F9.7 §7 Q10–22 (mesh, IP)	Mixed: 1 passage + 5 quant	F8.5 §8 errors only	F8.7 §7 errors only	Full mock 1

3.3 Weeks 9 to 12 — error-log drilling and timed sections

From here the calendar stops introducing material. **Everything is either an error you have already made or a timed section.** This is deliberate: in the last four weeks, retrieval beats coverage.

Week	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat
9	Error log, English half	Error log, Quant half	F8.1 all 40, timed	F8.6 all 30, timed	Mixed 15, timed	Timed English section
10	Error log, English half	Error log, Quant half	F8.4 all 30, timed	F8.5 all 35, timed	Mixed 15, timed	Full mock 2
11	Error log, whole	F8.7 all 30, timed	F8.2 + F8.3, timed	F8.8 all 25, timed	Mixed 15, timed	Timed Quant section
12	Wall sheets only	Wall sheets only	Error log, whole	Speed tables	Mixed 15, timed	Full mock 3

ACTION · WHAT TO DO IF YOU MISS A DAY

Do not double up the next day, and do not try to catch up. Skip the missed cell and do the current day's cell.

The value of this programme is the **daily habit**, not the completion of every cell. A candidate who does 60 of the 72 days in order will score better than one who does all 72 in bursts of four, because the spacing is doing as much work as the content. Missing Tuesday and doing Wednesday's cell on Wednesday costs you almost nothing. Abandoning the programme because you fell three days behind costs you the whole 80 marks' worth of practice.

4. The Speed Material

Two kinds of thing belong in a daily drill and nowhere else: **numbers you should never compute**, and **words you should already know**.

4.1 Numbers you should never compute

MUST MASTER · SQUARES TO 30, AND THE FRACTION EQUIVALENTS

Every one of these should be instant recall. Computing them mid-question wastes the seconds you need for the actual problem.

Squares 1 to 30:

n	n ²	n	n ²	n	n ²
11	121	18	324	25	625
12	144	19	361	26	676
13	169	20	400	27	729
14	196	21	441	28	784
15	225	22	484	29	841
16	256	23	529	30	900
17	289	24	576		

Cubes 1 to 12: 1, 8, 27, 64, 125, 216, 343, 512, 729, 1000, 1331, 1728

Fraction, decimal and percentage equivalents — the single highest-value table for arithmetic speed:

Fraction	Percentage	Fraction	Percentage
1/2	50%	1/8	12.5%
1/3	33⅓%	1/9	11⅓%
1/4	25%	1/11	9⅓%
1/5	20%	1/12	8⅓%
1/6	16⅔%	1/16	6.25%
1/7	14⅒%	1/20	5%

Why this table matters more than it looks. A question asking for "an increase of 16⅔%" is asking you to **multiply by 7/6**. Recognising the fraction turns a decimal calculation into a

one-step multiplication. Almost every percentage question in an aptitude paper is built on these equivalents.

Powers of 2: 2, 4, 8, 16, 32, 64, 128, 256, 512, 1024 — needed for F9.5's number systems too.

4.2 The vocabulary drip — ten words a day

Vocabulary is **half the English block** and is the only topic in the paper that responds better to **five minutes daily for twelve weeks** than to twelve hours in one week. Words need repeated exposure at intervals; they cannot be crammed.

The protocol:

1. Take **ten words** a day from the list in **F8.1 \$5**
2. For each, write the word, its meaning, and **one sentence of your own using it**
3. The next day, before taking ten new words, **cover the meanings and test yourself on yesterday's ten**
4. Every Saturday, test yourself on all sixty from that week
5. Any word you fail twice goes into the **error log** and is re-tested weekly

Ten words a day for twelve weeks is **840 exposures over 720 words** — which, at the observed weight of ten vocabulary questions in the paper, is the best-returning five minutes in this entire manual.

5. The Error Log

MUST MASTER · THE SINGLE HIGHEST-VALUE HABIT IN THE PROGRAMME

Everything else in this document is scheduling. **This section is the part that actually raises your score.**

A question you got wrong and understood is worth several questions you got right. But that only holds if you **return to it**, and you will not return to it unless it is written down somewhere you look.

Keep one page per subject, in this format:

Date	Source	What I chose	Correct	Why I got it wrong — in my own words
18 Aug	F8.5 Q14	62.5%	60%	Used 5/8 instead of 3/5. Did not check the fraction
18 Aug	F8.1 Q7	<i>reticent</i>	<i>recalcitrant</i>	Guessed from a similar-sounding word

The fourth column is the whole point. "Silly mistake" is not a diagnosis and teaches nothing. The diagnosis must be specific enough to be actionable — *"I applied the percentage before deducting"*, *"I read 'not correct' as 'correct'"*, *"I did not convert km/h to m/s"*.

Because when you have twenty entries you will find that **four or five root causes produce most of your errors**, and those four or five are what you fix. That is a far smaller and more tractable problem than "get better at Quant".

5.1 The weekly review, fifteen minutes on Saturday

1. Re-attempt every error from the week **without looking at the answer**
2. Any error you repeat gets a **star** — starred items are re-tested every Saturday until clean
3. Count your root causes and name the **top three** for the week
4. Write one line: *what will I do differently next week?*

THINK LIKE UPSC · THE THREE ERROR CAUSES THAT WILL DOMINATE YOUR LOG

Predicted from the trap patterns across this manual, and worth watching for from day one.

1. **Missing the word "not".** Blueprint §6 records that about **20%** of the 2023 paper used the "which one is **not** correct" format. Blueprint §8's remedy is a two-second habit: **re-read the last six words of the stem before you fill any bubble**
2. **Unit and conversion failures.** km/h to m/s (F9.1 §2.2), percentage before deduction (F6.3 §5.3), the wrong power of ten in pH (F9.3 §3.2). These are not knowledge failures, and they are the cheapest to eliminate
3. **Formula swaps within a matched pair.** Years'-purchase versus capitalisation (F6.4), mirror versus lens (F9.2), $n(n-1)$ versus $n(n-1)/2$ (F9.7). The examiner offers the other member of the pair, correctly computed

6. Attempt Strategy for the Real Paper

Restating the two calculations from Blueprint §1.2 and §1.5, because the drill exists to serve them.

The marking scheme. +2.5 for a correct answer, **-0.8333** for a wrong one, 0 for a blank. A blind guess among four options has an expected value of **exactly zero** — not negative.

MUST MASTER · THE ATTEMPT RULE

If you can eliminate even one option, you must attempt the question. Eliminating one leaves an expected value of +0.28; eliminating two, +0.83.

Over-cautious candidates leave 20 to 25 such questions blank and give away **six to eight marks of pure expected value**.

Leave a question blank only in two situations: you have **no basis whatever** for elimination, or you feel actively **pulled towards a familiar-looking option** — which usually means you have half-recognised a trap.

Your target: about 100 attempts at 80% accuracy, which gives roughly 183 of 300. Attempting more only pays if accuracy holds — 110 attempts at 70% scores *less* than 100 at 80%.

6.1 The three-pass method

Do not work through the paper in order. Three passes:

Pass	What you do	Time
First	Answer everything you know immediately . Skip anything needing calculation or deliberation	about 45 min
Second	Return to the calculable ones — mensuration, DI, arithmetic. You now know how much time you have per question	about 55 min
Third	Eliminate and guess on the rest. Fill every bubble where you can rule out one option	about 20 min

The reason this works: the paper mixes formats of wildly different cost, and the order is not sorted by difficulty. A 20-second vocabulary question sitting at number 95 is worth the same 2.5 marks as a 90-second mensuration problem at number 12. **A single pass in order means you may never reach the cheap marks.**

ACTION · START TOMORROW

Do not read the eight chapters first. **Go to §3, week 1, Monday — F8.1 §7 Q1–20 — and do it tomorrow evening.** Read the chapter sections as the calendar reaches them.

The chapters are:

Ch	Topic	Q
F8.1	Vocabulary in context — half the English block	40
F8.2	Para jumbles and sentence rearrangement	20
F8.3	Reading comprehension	20
F8.4	Grammar essentials and error spotting	30
F8.5	Arithmetic — ratio, percentage, average, ages, mixtures, time and work	35
F8.6	Mensuration and geometry	30
F8.7	Algebra, probability and the number system	30
F8.8	Data interpretation, and reasoning essentials	25